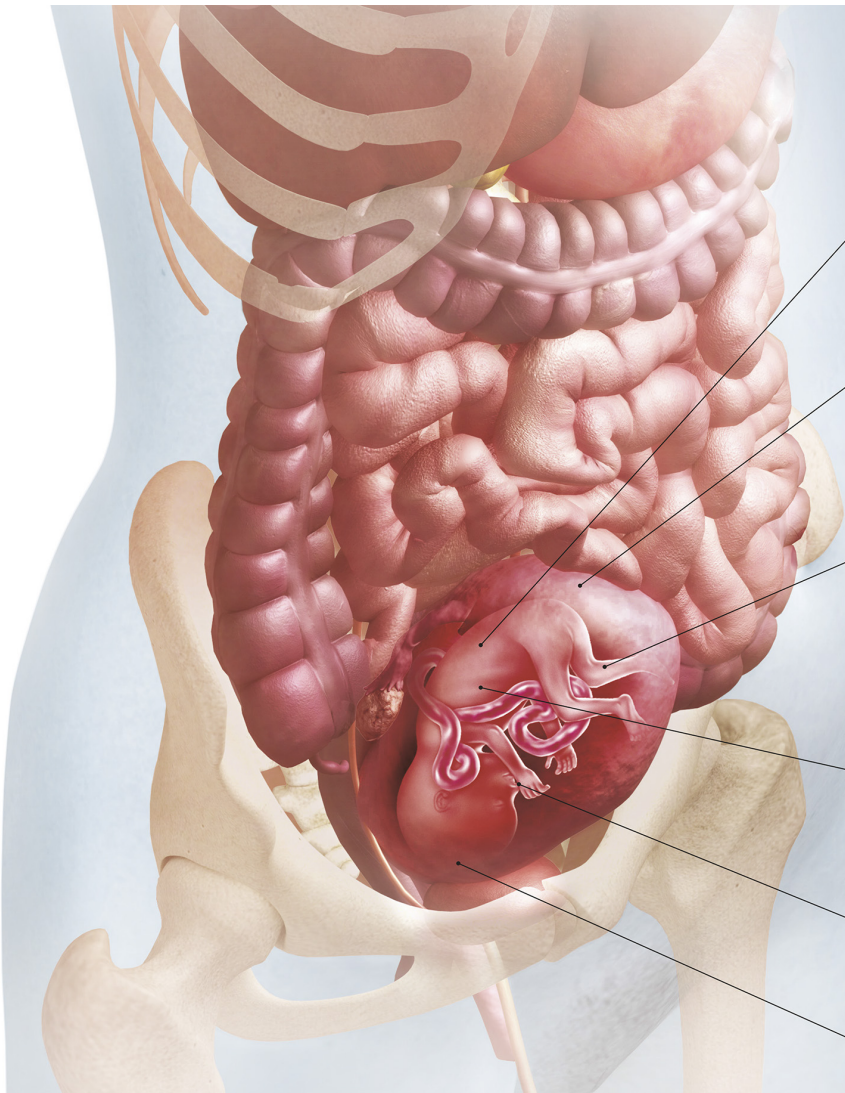




Fluid is pushed out of the lungs as the baby practices breathing movements.

The expanding uterus is now pushing up against your other abdominal organs.

Curling and stretching, arms and legs flailing, the baby is constantly changing position, lying first head-up and then head-down.

The baby's rapid heartbeat, easily distinguished from your own, may be strong enough for a doctor to detect with a handheld probe.

The mouth opens and shuts regularly, and your baby can swallow, may yawn, and occasionally hiccups.

At 17 weeks the average crown to rump length is 5.1 in (13 cm) and the average weight is 5 oz (140 g).